

Gracious Savior, Gentle Shepherd

- 1 Gracious Savior, gentle Shepherd,
little ones are dear to thee;
gathered with thine arms and carried
in thy bosom, may they be
sweetly, gently, safely tended,
from all want and danger free.
- 2 Tender Shepherd, never leave them,
from thy fold to go astray;
by thy look of love directed,
may they walk the narrow way;
thus direct them, and protect them,
lest they fall an easy prey.
- 3 Let thy holy Word instruct them:
fill their minds with heav'nly light;
let thy love and grace constrain them
to approve whate'er is right,
take thine easy yoke and wear it,
and to prove thy burden light.
- 4 Cleanse their hearts from sinful folly
in the stream thy love supplied;
mingled streams of blood and water
flowing from thy wounded side:
and to heav'nly pastures lead them,
where thine own still waters glide.

Words: Jane E. Leeson, 1842; adapt. John Keble, 1857; alt.

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